Rylan Stalnaker

SOC Analyst | Security Operations | SIEM & Incident Analysis
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Entry-level SOC Analyst with hands-on experience in threat detection, alert triage, log analysis, and incident investigation using Wazuh SIEM across Windows and Linux endpoints. Designed and deployed a home lab simulating real-world attack scenarios — including brute-force authentication, privilege escalation, and defense evasion — and documented findings in structured incident reports aligned with NIST SP 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK. Holds a B.S. in Cybersecurity and Information Assurance (WGU) with a CompTIA certification stack including CySA+ and Security+. Focused on accurate triage, false positive reduction, and clear, audit-ready documentation.

CYBERSECURITY PROJECTS

SIEM Security Monitoring Lab — WGU Capstone
2025 – Present

Independent Project

- Deployed a centralized Wazuh SIEM on Ubuntu Server with Windows and Linux endpoints on an isolated NAT virtual network, simulating a small enterprise SOC environment.
- Simulated and detected attack scenarios mapped to MITRE ATT&CK: brute-force authentication (T1110.001), new account creation and privilege escalation (T1136.001, T1098), firewall disablement via Set-NetFirewallProfile (T1562.004), and file permission modification (T1222.002).
- Performed alert triage and log analysis in the Wazuh Dashboard; correlated alerts to Windows Security Event IDs (4624, 4625, 4720, 4732) and Wazuh rule IDs to identify indicators of compromise.
- Documented findings in a structured incident report following NIST SP 800-61 Rev. 2 phases: Detection & Analysis, Containment, Eradication, Recovery, and Post-Incident Activity.
- Identified false positive patterns and documented detection tuning recommendations based on simulated attack behavior.

Active Directory User Management Lab
2025

Independent Project

- Built and configured Windows Server 2019 Active Directory with DNS, DHCP, and NAT/RRAS in a virtualized environment to simulate enterprise identity and access management.
- Automated provisioning of 1,000+ domain accounts using PowerShell, enforcing naming standards and group membership policies.

TryHackMe — SOC Level 1 & Security Labs
2024 – Present

Independent Study

- Completed 10+ structured labs across offensive tooling and web fundamentals; each write-up documents investigation methodology, evidence, and defensive takeaways aligned to SOC analyst workflows.
- Actively progressing through SOC Level 1 path with focus on network analysis, phishing investigation, and Windows Event Log analysis.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

VR Technology Consultant — American Indian Resource Center, Tahlequah OK
May 2026 – Jun 2026

- Deployed and configured Meta Quest 3S headsets across four rural school sites, managing device setup and account provisioning from scratch.
- Developed a complete teacher training program including instructional guides, application reference materials, and a self-sufficient on-boarding document for future staff.
- Served as sole technical point-of-contact throughout the contract, handling troubleshooting and escalations independently.

Accounting Associate — Cherokee Nation Entertainment, Tahlequah OK
Oct 2023 – Aug 2024

- Identified and corrected data discrepancies through systematic record review, demonstrating the analytical attention to detail required for alert triage and incident documentation.
- Collaborated cross-functionally to meet strict monthly closing deadlines, demonstrating reliability in structured, process-driven workflows.

Call Support Specialist — Provalus, Tahlequah OK
Jun 2023 – Oct 2023

- Investigated and resolved system and network issues by analyzing logs and system behavior to identify root causes — directly applicable to SOC triage and incident analysis.
- Documented technical incidents and resolutions in a repeatable format to support consistent troubleshooting and knowledge sharing.

IT Help Desk Technician — Fort Lewis College, Durango CO Aug 2021 – Jun 2022

- Provided technical support across Windows and Linux environments; escalated complex cases and documented resolutions to enable efficient knowledge transfer.

VR Lab Specialist — American Indian Resource Center, Tahlequah OK May 2020 – Jun 2023

- Implemented and maintained security protocols within the lab environment to ensure data protection and system integrity.

CORE SKILLS

Security Operations: SIEM (Wazuh, Splunk), alert triage & incident investigation, log analysis & correlation, threat detection & analysis, false positive reduction, detection tuning

Frameworks & Standards: NIST SP 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK (technique & sub-technique mapping), incident response lifecycle

Endpoint & Cloud: Windows Event Logs, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (foundational), Linux security monitoring, Azure (in progress)

Systems & Networking: Active Directory, DNS, DHCP, TCP/IP, Windows Server 2019, Ubuntu Linux

Scripting: PowerShell (automation, user provisioning), basic Python

Tools: Wazuh, Splunk, Nmap, Metasploit, Wireshark, Hydra, Gobuster, Burp Suite

Documentation: NIST-aligned incident reports, SOC-style investigation write-ups, audit-ready ticket documentation

EDUCATION

B.S. Cybersecurity and Information Assurance — Western Governors University (Aug 2023 – Mar 2026)

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA CySA+	09/2025 – 09/2031
CompTIA Security Analytics Professional	09/2025 – 09/2031
CompTIA PenTest+	01/2026 – 01/2029
CompTIA Network Vulnerability Assessment Professional	01/2026 – 01/2029
CompTIA Network Security Professional	01/2026 – 01/2029
CompTIA Security+	06/2024 – 09/2031
CompTIA Secure Infrastructure Specialist	06/2024 – 09/2031
CompTIA Network+	01/2024 – 09/2031
CompTIA IT Operations Specialist	01/2024 – 09/2031
CompTIA A+	09/2023 – 09/2031
Associate of ISC2 (SSCP)	02/2025 – 02/2027
ITIL 4 Foundation	09/2024 – 09/2027
CompTIA Project+ (PK0-005)	07/2025
Linux Essentials	12/2024

PROFESSIONAL ASSOCIATIONS

ISC2 Member